C5 The Victorian Age

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Introduction

Class Notes

- 1837 ⇒ 1901 ⇒ Queen Victoria, longest reign;
- *What is the difference between kingdom and empire?* → Empire spreads across seas;
- *What does the victorian age rappresent? (Victorian Facade)* ↓
  - On one hand, the most powerful country of the world (due to imperialism)
    - Control of Raw Materials
    - Political control of other countries
    - Richness was for the few (concentration of wealth) ⇒ average man lived in precarious conditions ⇒ no redistribiution of wealth;
  - On the other hand,
    - Proud, intollerant, "superior",
    - "The Burden of the white man" ⇒ duty of cilizing the world
    - Status quo ⇒ do ut des
    - Sono abituati a non esternare i propri sentimenti ⇒ dopo un po scoppiano
    - Da secoli, la leadership britannica viene allevata a non esternare i propri sentimenti
- *Why did the English Empire support the italian union?* → To take power away from france and Austria;

The Victorian Age

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Victorian Values

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CLIL

Theory of Evolution

- Before ⇒ living beings conceived by god
- Charles Robert Darwin ⇒ Natural Selection
- Traveled with the **HMS Beagle** since 1831 to 1836
  - Brought back fossils and live specimens
  - Milodon ⇒ probably ancestor of the sloth
- Stop at the Galapagos Islands
  - Giant tortoises ⇒ unique characteristics of the turtles between the islands
  - *Explain how the giant tortoise adapted differently between the dry and humid island* ↓
    - Dry island ⇒ food is higher up ⇒ longer necks of the tortoise & shape of the shell can camouflage in the dry environment;
    - Humid island ⇒ food is lower and more available ⇒ bigger and stronger shell to defend against predators & shorter neck to be able to hide within the shell;
  - Comparison between artificial selection (when breeding biards) and natural systems
- *What did Thomas Robert Malthus theorise?* ↓
  - As pop in europe was growing ⇒ food would not be sufficient ⇒ fight for survival ⇒ survival of the fittest;
  - The fittest *(most apt)* individuals have greater chances of reproducing and passing on their characteristics to the future generations;
- Alfred Russell Wallace arrived at the same conclusion of Darwin ⇒ Darwin rushed to publish in order to receive the credit;
- What did Darwin's theories state?

7 Milion YUears of Human Evolution

Dystopian novels

- Beginning of dystopian novels ⇒ Earwhon

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- *What is "**Earwhon**" by Samuel Butler? ↓*
  - Nowhere ⇒ non luogo (Utopia, too beautiful to exist);
  - Now – here ⇒
- Hidden society based on utilitarianism
- Crime was treated as an illness to treat ⇒ criminals are put in hospitals
- Sickness is treated as a waste

C5.1 The dawn of ethe Victorian Age

- **Queen Victoria** 2
- **Age of reform**
- **Workhouses and religion**
  - **Life in a victorian workhouse** 2

    www.youtube.com/watch?v=1 ... + New Source
  - **Charlie Chaplin**
    - Charlie, Sydney and Hannah Chaplin joined a workhouse
    - Sister Sydney abused in the workhouse ⇒ after 7 weeks sent to an insane asylum;
    - Charlie sent to a pauper school (too young to work) ⇒ rudimentary education for poor children;
  - **Conditions**
    - *How many people went through workhouses? How many died? ↓*
      - 16 million people went through workhouses;
      - 5 million people died;
    - *When and why were the workhouses first adopted? ↓*
      - Adopted in 1834 ⇒ humiliate the poor for asking for help
    - *What happened as soon as you joined the workhouse and why? ↓*
      - **Segregation** ⇒ Families seprated between male and female, children and adults;
      - Belief that the segregation would "contain the toxic trait of poverty"
    - *What is an example of rooms in a workhouse? ↓*
      - Lobby
      - Lavatory

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    - Lobby and lavatory
    - Officers lavatory
    - Day room for able-bodied (good)
    - Day room for able-bodied (bad)
    - Attendants sitting-room
    - Day room for aged
- *Why was there a difference between the day-roos for good and bad (able-bodied)?* → Disencourage bad behaviour;
- *Where did the irish immigrants go?* ↓
    - **Northern England** ⇒ Burmingan, Liverpool, were the most industrially developed;
    - **Scotland** (because it was closer) ⇒ Glasgow;
- *Why did irish people immigrate into Scotland and Northern England?* ↓
    - The Irish **Famine**;
- *What was the poor-house?* → Scottish version of the workhouse;
- A Modest Proposal by Jonathan Swift⇒ proposal to start eating children to survive the famine in Ireland;
- *What were the conditions in industrial cities?* ↓
    - **Overcrowding** ⇒ up to 50 people per tenament (small house with a couple of rooms);
    - 1 room per family ⇒ no heating, damp (muffa);
    - **No sewage systems** ⇒ poor hygene;
    - **Precarious** conditions;
    - **High child mortality rate** ⇒ 1 every 5 children died;
- 100000 people in Glasgow alone living in precarious conditions
- In 1900, 1 third of the urban population was living in poverty
- Up to 600 workhouses in England
- *What were the working conditions of workhouses?* ↓
    - 10 hours a day, 6 days a week
    - Precarious jobs (breaking rocks, roads, dividing ropes into fragments)
    - Treated like prisoners and slaves
    - People could leave, but weren't able to;

        - No pension
    - Sick people were sent to hospitals ⇒ after death the corpses were used for students to study and were dysected ⇒ very bad because of the christian believes of the afterlife;
  - **Families**
    - *Why did people have so many children?* ↓
      - No contraceptives;
      - Sex as an only way out;
      - High child mortality rate ⇒ replacing children;
    - *How is the Victorian family and Brave new world connected?* ↓
      - High natality rate ⇒ dead children were "replaed"
      - In Brave new world children are produced in series, like the **Ford Model T,** through the Loading;
- **Chartism**
- **The Irish Potato Famine**
- **Technological progress**
- **Foreign policy**
- **Gentrification**
  - *What is gentrification?* → Richest bought all the fields ⇒ small farmers couldn't resist;

C5.2 The Victorian compromise

- A complex age
- Respectability
- Life in Victorian Britain

Discoveries in Medicine

- The father of epidemiology
- Surgery and anaesthesia

C5.3 Early Victorian thinkers

- Evangelicalism
- Jeremy Bentham's Utilitarianism
  - Believed in women and gary rights, abolition of slavery, freedom of speech;
  - *What is pleasure according to Bentham?* ↓

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        - High **quantity** pleasure;
        - Communal happiness (total amount);
    - *What are the 2 types of pleasure?* ↓
        - Intellectual pleasure
        - Physical pleasure
    - *What are Bentham's pleasure types?* ↓
        - Quality
        - Quantity
        - Intensity
        - Purity
        - Vicinity
    - *What were Natural Rights during the Victorian Age? Who did they apply to?* ↓
        - Applied only to white men;
        - Natural rights ⇒ only natural for white men;
        - Right to prevail over other inferior humans;
    - Why did Bentham and Mill go against the Natural Rights?
- James Stuart Mill and the empiricist tradition

Analysis

    - *Is Utilitarianism so distant from reality?* ↓
        - US Capitalism;
    - *What is the difference between Capitalism and Utilitarianism?* ↓

      Back of card
    - What are the differences between Universalism and Relativism?
- Challenges from the scientific field

C5.4 The American Civil War

- **Introduction**
    - North ⇒ Industrial, similar to the UK (paid workers, often immigrants)
    - South ⇒ slavery
    - In the parliament, there are 2 reppresentatives per state;
- **The difference between North and South**

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- *What was the name of the line that divided North and South?* → **Mason-Dixon Line**

- **The Civil War**
  - *What were the reasons behind the civil war?* ↓
    - Economics (of cotton)
    - Slavery
  - *What sparked the civil war?* ↓
    - Revisionists state that the declaration of Indipendence states that Washington cannot impose laws on the local levelf, so it was within their right to keep slavery;
  - *Armies in the civil war* ↓
    - Infantry
    - Chivalry
    - Artillery
    - Guerrilla
  - *What were the main objectives in the war?* ↓
    - Destroying artillery;
    - Destroying the navy;
  - *Why did France support explicitly the Confederates?* ↓
    - To contrast the US's power;
  - Il nord stabilisce un embargo sul Sud;
  - Southern slaves escaped and joined the Northern army as they were promised a salary ⇒ North tried not to give the salary;
  - *What was the UK's role in the american civil war?* ↓
    - Ambiguous, double faced;
    - The UK abolished slavery, but they partake in the trade of slavery;
    - They formally supported the North, but in practice they protected the confederates;
- **The abolition of slavery**
- **A new version of the American dream**
- **The expansion of settlements in the West**

C5.5 The later years of Queen VIctoria's reign

- **The liberal and the Conservative Parties**
  - Prince Albert died of typhoid in 1861 ⇒ **Queen Victoria** withdrew from society for 10 years ⇒ regrouping of the parties;
  - **The Liberal Party** ↕
    - Includes former **Whigs**, radicals and a large minority of businessmen;
    - Led by William Gladstone;
  - **The Conservative Party** ↕
    - Includes the former **Tories**
    - Led by Benjamin Disraeli;
- **Benjamin Disraeli**
  - Became prime minister in 1968 and then again in 1974 movie;
  - **Artisans' and Labourers' Dwellings Act** ↕
    - Allowed local public authorities to clear the slums;
    - Provided housing for the poor;
  - **Public Health Act** ↕
    - Provided sanitation;
    - Provided running water;
  - **Factory Act** ↕
    - Limited the working hours per week;
  - **Eastern Question** ↕
    - Decay of the ottoman empire
    - Attempt of other european powers to gain influence in the middle-east;
  - Encouraged england to invest in the Suez Canale
- **William Gladstone**
  - Prime minister for 4 times
  - Introduced "**Board Schools**"
  - **Trade Unions Act** ↕
    - Trade unions become legal;
  - **Ballot Act** ↕
    - Secret ballot;
  - **The Third Reform Act** ↕

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        - extended voting to all male **householders**;
    - **Irish Parliamentary Party** ↕
        - Sitting at the english parialment;
        - Requests indipendence of Ireland;
- **The Anglo-Boer Wars**
    - Boers were a popolation coming from the Netherlands and Belgium ⇒ they wanted control of southern Africa;
        - For precious metals, precious woods, ivory;
- **Empress of India**
- **The end of an era**
    - **Queen Victoria** died in 1901;
    - Victoria restored the love for the crown in the britsh population;
    - Tutto viene velocizzato ⇒ trasporto, comunicazione

C5.14 Charles Dickens

Introduction

- **Context**
    - Context of the Life in a victorian workhouse;
    - Parallel with US slavery
- **Life and works**
    - What characterized Charles Dickens's childhood? ↓
        - Born in southern England in 1812;
        - Father inmprisoned for debt when he was 12;
        - He was sent to a workhouse;
        - Later he was sent to a school in London;
        - At 15 he found employment as an office boy at a lawyer's and continued his studies;
    - *What are the main aspects of Charles Dickens writing?* ↓
        - Didactic stance – educating the rich about the conditions of the poor;
        - Always sided with the poor;
        - He witnessed what he wrote ⇒ thanks to his job at the lawyer's and due to his own experience, like C3 Alessandro Manzoni;

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- Specific language based on the social class and context, like Giovanni Verga;
- Talking names ⇒ names reppresent the characters, e.g. oliver **Twist** (twisted life)**Talking names ⇒ names reppresent the characters, e.g. oliver Twist (twisted life);**;

- **Themes**

- **Characters**
- **A diadactic aim**
- **Style and reputation**

Hard Times 1

Oliver Twist Charles Dickens ✕ 1

Work and Alienation

- Connection with Brave new world
- Connection with Karl Marx
- Connection with Giovanni Verga ⇒ Rosso Malpelo

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